

CASE91 - Lar Casa de Magalhaes

OUTPUT - PREPROCESS MODULE FORMAT (ENGLISH)

Project: Lar Casa de Magalhes

Architect: Atelier Carvalho Arajo

Location: Guimares, Portugal

Source: <https://www.archdaily.com/235250/lar-casa-de-magalhaes-atelier-carvalho-araujo>

LEVEL COUNT: 1 (Single-story residential facility)

Level 1

Vocabulary Extraction

- Social courtyard
- Service courtyard
- Bedrooms (27)
- Social areas
- Service areas
- Ring circulation corridor
- Main entrance
- Service entrance
- Existing house structure (preserved)

Quantity Estimation

- Bedrooms 27
- Courtyards 2 (1 social, 1 service)
- Entrances 2 (main and service)

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- Circulation corridor 1 (ring-shaped)

Spatial Relationship Descriptions

- All spatial programs are arranged around two inner courtyards, creating a ring-shaped circulation.
- The social courtyard is encircled by bedrooms and social zones, promoting interaction among residents.
- The service courtyard is surrounded by support spaces such as storage, laundry, and service kitchens.
- Dual-access strategy: the main entrance is separated from the service entrance, ensuring functional zoning.
- The preserved house anchors the public-facing portion of the site and defines the historical footprint.

Overall Spatial Impression

The spatial layout emphasizes centripetal organization with strong internal orientation. Courtyard-centered circulation maximizes daylight and promotes community, while service and private domains are clearly demarcated.

Image Interpretation (P2 & P3)

Design Vocabulary Extraction

- Vertical rhythm faade
- Whitewashed walls
- Deep window recesses
- Concrete and glass materiality
- Inner courtyards as light wells

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- Horizontal slab profile

Atmospheric Description

The atmosphere is serene, meditative, and grounded. Daylight permeates softly through courtyards, while the use of white render and textured concrete enhances spatial clarity and thermal comfort.

Spatial Composition or Hierarchy

The building uses axial voids (courtyards) to define clear spatial rhythm. A primary ring path links all units and functions, reinforcing movement continuity and hierarchy from public to private zones.

Design Intent Reading

The project reinterprets institutional living through a domestic scale. It emphasizes dignity, familiarity, and landscape integration. The use of preserved elements symbolizes memory and continuity.

Contextual Relationship

The faade mimics tree trunks, aligning rhythmically with the surrounding woodland. The building's low profile and monochromatic treatment embed it harmoniously in the natural environment.